Pardis Sadat Zahraei

zahraei2@illinois.edu Pardis Sadat Zahraei pardis-zahraei @PardisZahraei PardisSzah

Education

PhD in Computer Science — Aug 2025 – May 2030
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign (UIUC) — *Illinois, USA*
- Advised by Prof. Gökhan Tür and Prof. Dilek Hakkani-Tür

B.Sc in Computer Engineering — Nov 2020 - Jul. 2025
Sharif University of Technology — *Final Grade: 18.27/20*

Publications

Emergent Unfaithfulness: How Alignment Training Causes Language Models to Silently Override Task Faithfulness
*Authors: **Pardis Sadat Zahraei**, Janvijay Singh, Gokhan Tur, Dilek Hakkani-Tür*
Under Review - COLM 2026

EiCAP: Benchmarking and Enhancing Emotional Intelligence in LLMs through Psychologically Grounded Multi-Turn Dialogue
*Authors: Nizi Nazar, **Pardis Sadat Zahraei**, Dilek Hakkani-Tür, Natasa Milic-Frayling, Ehsaneddin Asgari*
Under Review - COLM 2026

Prior Beliefs Prejudice LLM-as-Judge: Evidence from Persuasion Evaluation
*Authors: **Pardis Sadat Zahraei**, Xiaoning Wang, Beyza Bozdag, Gokhan Tur, Dilek Hakkani-Tur*
Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2026

I Am Aligned, But With Whom? Diagnosing Structural Alignment Failures in LLMs
*Authors: **Pardis Sadat Zahraei**, Ehsaneddin Asgari*
Under Review - Neurips 2026

WSC+: Enhancing The Winograd Schema Challenge Using Tree-of-Experts
*Authors: **Pardis Sadat Zahraei**, Ali Emami*
EACL 2024 (Oral Presentation)

TuringQ: Benchmarking AI Comprehension in Theory of Computation
*Authors: **Pardis Sadat Zahraei**, Ehsaneddin Asgari*
Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP 2024

Translate With Care: Addressing Gender Bias, Neutrality, and Reasoning in LLM Translations
*Authors: **Pardis Sadat Zahraei**, Ali Emami*
Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2025 - (Lightning Talk at GeBNLP Workshop)

Detecting Bias and Enhancing Diagnostic Accuracy in Large Language Models for Healthcare
*Authors: **Pardis Sadat Zahraei**, Zahra Shakeri*

Generative AI for Character Animation: A Comprehensive Survey
*Authors: Mohammad Mahdi Abootorabi, Omid Ghahroodi, **Pardis Sadat Zahraei**, et al.*

Research Interests

- Scalable Oversight & Model Evaluation
- Post-Training & RLHF Methods
- AI Safety and Alignment
- Adversarial Robustness & Model Interpretability

Teaching & Academic Service

- **Teaching Assistant:** Machine Learning, Natural Language Processing, Artificial Intelligence, and Modern Information Retrieval *Sharif University of Technology — 2023-2024*
- **Reviewer:** ACL, EACL, and EMNLP (4 ARR Cycles, 2024–2025)